

Hamza Abu Ayyash

CREATIVE DIRECTOR & AI CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST

BASE — AMMAN, JO / GHENT, BE

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Creative Director and researcher with 15+ years shaping visual identity at the intersection of cinematic branding, AI-driven creative technology, and public-space intervention. KASK alumnus (MA, 2021) specializing in semiotics, counter-memory, and institutional critique. Lead visual designer for the Palestine Film Institute since 2018 — delivering identities for Cannes, Berlinale, IDFA, and TIFF — and founder of The-247, a research studio building agentic AI workflows and custom LoRA models for the creative sector.



EXPERIENCE

2025–
Present

Founder & Creative AI Lead

THE-247 — AMMAN / REMOTE

- Lead a research-driven studio building agentic AI workflows for film, branding, and cultural institutions, bridging visual strategy with applied machine learning.
- Develop custom LoRA models and archival training datasets to explore synthetic heritage and counter-bias in generative media.
- Architect end-to-end production pipelines integrating ComfyUI, ControlNet, and local SLMs (Ollama) for high-volume creative output.

2018–
Present

Head of Visual Design

PALESTINE FILM INSTITUTE — CANNES / BERLIN / GHENT

- Direct the institute's visual identity across eight Cannes editions (2018–2026), including the 2026 Palestine Pavilion at the 79th Cannes Film Festival.
- Lead identity systems for international showcases at Berlinale, IDFA, and TIFF, translating cinematic narratives into cohesive institutional branding.
- Manage cross-disciplinary teams of designers, illustrators, and motion artists across print, motion, environmental, and digital deliverables.

2016–
Present

Co-Developer & Principal Investigator

THE INFL3CTOR PROJECT — BELGIUM / GERMANY / PALESTINE

- Co-developed a custom handheld projection-mapping device enabling performative Digital Calligraffiti in public space.
- Conducted multi-year HCI field research and public interventions documenting institutional friction in urban contexts.
- Presented outcomes at international academic and cultural venues, generating peer-reviewed citations across HCI and contemporary art discourse.

TECHNICAL
ARSENAL

GENERATIVE AI ComfyUI (advanced workflows), LoRA training, ControlNet, local SLMs (Ollama), prompt engineering, synthetic dataset curation.	AUDIOVISUAL & MOTION Adobe Creative Suite (expert), After Effects, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Cinema 4D.
CREATIVE TECH & ARCHITECTURE Projection mapping (Resolume Arena), hardware prototyping (Infl3ctor), real-time visual systems, stage & environmental design.	CORE STRATEGY Creative direction, design strategy, production design, cross-cultural storytelling, institutional critique.

RESEARCH &
PROJECTS

2024–Present	Algorithmic Agonism Investigating the role of AI agents as co-authors in decolonial public art; building experimental pipelines combining LoRA-trained models with public-space intervention.
2021 MA Thesis	Intervention in Western Monuments Semiotic study of counter-memory in Ghent's historical sites, proposing strategies through which Digital Calligraffiti adds new content and form to Western monuments and symbols.
2015	Archaeology of Light EU-funded research residency in Italy exploring projection mapping on cultural heritage and the choreography of architecture through light.

FILMOGRAPHY
ART DEPT.

Once Upon a Time in Gaza 2024 Feature — Art Dept. / Graffiti Artist · Dir. Arab & Tarzan Nasser	Nemshi? 2024 Short Film — Production Designer
Lyd 2023 Documentary / Sci-fi — Graphic Designer	Infidel 2019 Feature — Art Dept. / Scenic Artist
The Man Who Stole Banksy 2018 Documentary — Featured Artist	Paradise Now 2005 Feature — Actor

EDUCATION

2019–21	MA, Autonomous Design KASK & CONSERVATORIUM — GHENT, BELGIUM
2000–04	BA, Interior Design AN-NAJAH NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

EXHIBITIONS &
PUBLICATIONS

Rooted in Resilience — Viernulvier, Ghent (BE)	2025
Not Numbers & DAL-L — Graphic Novels (Author & Illustrator)	2024–25
Benefit for Gaza — NTGent (Online)	2023
Calligraffiti Ambassador of Palestine — Milan, Italy	2015

LANGUAGES

Arabic (Native) · English (Professional) · Dutch (Basic)